Jesse — May 21 Return Brief

Built: April 28, 2026 (updated April 29 — DOAC removed, pricing + IG arc added)
Author: Junior
For: Jesse to read first thing on May 21, before opening email
Purpose: You've been at sea for two weeks. This document gets you operational in 20 minutes.

The Situation in One Paragraph

Modern Savage is on track for July 1 but two critical unknowns — ship date and domain — are still unresolved. CJ owned the May 4 EBG call and your absence. The launch infrastructure is now complete: 5-email sequence, post-purchase flow (6 emails), Klaviyo spec, pricing recommendation, Bear IG arc, WhatsApp community, press brief, influencer seeding, podcast targets, kids blend, Calvin SOW draft. The decisions waiting for you in your first week back: pricing (before Stripe), influencer seeding (by May 23), podcast target (by May 26), Calvin SOW (by May 26). Read this first, then open email.

BEFORE YOU SAILED — Did These Happen? (ask CJ first)

Three things should have happened before or just after you sailed on May 7. CJ should have the answers.

Olly operational? On April 24, Olly was still in hospital awaiting surgery (3 days in, still waiting). He was supposed to be your content approval authority during the sailing window. Ask: did Olly recover and return before May 7? If not, who has been approving Bear's social content? If nobody has — Phase 1 of the IG arc may not have run.

Bear IG content arc approved? Ten posts across four phases were staged for your approval before May 7. Olly was supposed to execute Phase 1 (May 1-21) while you sailed. If you didn't approve before leaving, ask CJ/Olly: did Phase 1 happen? Brief at workspace/docs/modern-savage-bear-ig-strategy-2026-04-28.pdf. If Phase 1 didn't run, the launch audience isn't primed — factor this into the July 1 timing assessment.

Pricing set? The Stripe account cannot be configured without a price. Brief with recommendation at workspace/docs/modern-savage-pricing-analysis-2026-04-28.pdf. Recommended: £59/month adult regular, £47/month founding member (20% off, 12-month lock). If this wasn't agreed before sailing, Stripe isn't live — which means Email 1 hasn't sent and the 170-person waitlist is still waiting.

PART 1 — Verify What CJ Was Supposed to Do

Ask CJ for a verbal status on these five items before anything else.

1. Ship date from Lightning Nutra — MOST IMPORTANT
CJ was supposed to email Chris Liming (chris@lightningnutra.com) on April 29 to confirm the product ship date for all three SKUs. The question was: "Can you confirm the expected ship date for the SuperHero Add On order? We need product at our UK fulfillment partner by June 25."

Ask CJ: "Do we have a confirmed ship date? Is it before or after June 25?"
- Before June 25: good. Proceed.
- After June 25: launch moves. See contingency brief at workspace/docs/modern-savage-manufacturing-contingency-2026-04-25.pdf.
- Still no answer: call Chris Liming yourself today. This is the single most important variable.

2. modernsavage.com — domain acquisition
CJ was managing a MediaOptions broker approach. Budget £2,000. Domain expires June 24 — a hard deadline.

Ask CJ: "Has MediaOptions made contact with the seller? What's the current status?"
If no progress by May 21: 34 days until expiry. Escalate urgently.

3. EBG May 4 call — what was decided
The May 4 Zoom happened while you were sailing. CJ should have a brief summary.

Ask CJ: "What was agreed and what was left open?" Key: did Bear commit to anything about the Creator Network or Modern Savage? Whatever Bear said is the reality you're managing from. Also: a new WhatsApp group (BG/JG/Del, April 22) revealed EBG is demanding 15% on ALL opportunities — not just Creator Network. This is new intelligence not in the May 4 prep brief. Brief at workspace/docs/ebg-new-intel-whatsapp-2026-04-28.pdf.

4. Twyn model from Zain
Zain Qazi was sending a revised Year 1/2/3 model the week of May 5. CJ was holding it for your return.

Ask CJ: "Has the Twyn model arrived? Can you forward it now?"
Reading guide at workspace/docs/twyn-financial-model-reading-guide-2026-04-25.pdf — read before opening the model.

5. Stripe + Ships A Lot Qwilr
Ask CJ: "Is the Stripe account live? Has the Ships A Lot Qwilr been signed?" Both were on the pre-sailing sprint. If Stripe isn't live, Email 1 hasn't gone out and the 170-person waitlist is still waiting.

PART 2 — Decisions Waiting for You (by deadline)

Immediate — Pricing (if not already set)

If pricing wasn't approved before sailing, this is Day 1. Stripe cannot be set up without it.

Recommendation: £59/month adult subscription, £47/month founding member (20% off, 12-month lock), £39/month kids, £89/month family bundle. Sits above Heart & Soil (~£44-52) and below AG1 (£79). Full rationale at workspace/docs/modern-savage-pricing-analysis-2026-04-28.pdf.

Critical: founding member price must NOT appear publicly until Email 4 (June 24). If it leaks before then, it anchors the public launch at the discount price.

By May 23 — Influencer Seeding List

Approve the 20-person target list. Ships A Lot needs to package and dispatch by June 1 for organic posts to land ahead of July 1.

Brief at workspace/docs/modern-savage-influencer-seeding-2026-04-28.pdf. **Bear's personal letters for Wim Hof and Ross Edgley are already drafted** — at workspace/docs/modern-savage-bear-letters-wim-ross-2026-04-29.md. What to do:
1. Read the letters (5 min, not 30) — approve or tweak
2. Confirm top 5 targets (Wim, Gary Brecka, Thomas DeLauer, Ant Middleton, Ross)
3. Check: does Bear have an existing WhatsApp with Wim or Ross? If yes, send digitally first
4. Tell Calvin to execute — letters, packaging, Ships A Lot dispatch

By May 26 — Podcast Target (replaced DOAC)

DOAC is off — Bear has already been on it. Two best alternatives: **Modern Wisdom** (Chris Williamson, 1M+ reach, perfect male 25-40 audience) and **Feel Better Live More** (Dr. Rangan Chatterjee, top UK health podcast). Pick one and make contact.

Full brief with booking approach, conflict checks, and framing for each at workspace/docs/modern-savage-podcast-targets-2026-04-28.pdf. If you have a personal line to Chris Williamson, a DM from Bear beats any booking form by a factor of ten.

By May 26 — Calvin Modern Savage SOW

The SOW draft is ready. Terms: $3,000/month from June 1, 2.5% equity at 5K subscribers + 2.5% at 10K. Three things to decide: start date (June 1 as drafted, or May 1 with £1,500 setup fee), equity percentages (2.5%+2.5% is what Calvin proposed — 1.5%+1.5% is more defensible for a part-time operator), and acquisition treatment of unvested equity.

Draft at workspace/docs/calvin-modern-savage-sow-draft-2026-04-28.pdf. Read it, mark your three decisions, send to Calvin. Do not give Calvin new paid work after May 26 without a signed agreement.

By May 28 — Twyn model response

After reviewing Zain's model: respond with direction. You don't need to accept or reject anything — just "we've reviewed, we have some questions, let's schedule a call for early June." Silence past May 28 risks them cooling off.

Before reading the model, read the deal assessment (workspace/docs/twyn-deal-assessment-2026-04-29.pdf). It covers: what Twyn actually is, the one question Zain can't dodge (Messi monthly active users), non-negotiables (IP reversion, data rights, minimum guarantee), and the honest verdict. Read the assessment first, then the model reading guide, then Zain's numbers.

PART 3 — Status Reading (no decisions, just context)

Read these after handling Part 2.

EBG full picture — Two documents. First: workspace/docs/ebg-new-intel-whatsapp-2026-04-28.pdf (new April 28 — EBG's actual position is a 15% flat commission on all opportunities, not just

Creator Network). Second: workspace/docs/may4-ebg-call-prep-2026-04-26.pdf (the Everest Fund production investment angle). Read both before your next conversation with Bear or Ben Simon.

Bear Instagram pre-launch arc — If Phase 1 didn't run while you were sailing, read workspace/docs/modern-savage-bear-ig-strategy-2026-04-28.pdf and assess what's salvageable. Phase 2 (May 22-June 14) still works even if Phase 1 is compressed. The Hint Post (Post 7, "I've been working on something for a while") should run before June 15.

Modern Savage launch infrastructure — All built. workspace/docs/modern-savage-launch-calendar-2026-04-28.pdf shows where everything should be as of May 21. Cross-check CJ's actual delivery against it. Also new since you left: WhatsApp Community strategy (workspace/docs/modern-savage-community-strategy-2026-04-28.pdf), Kids Blend brief (workspace/docs/modern-savage-kids-blend-brief-2026-04-29.pdf), Klaviyo setup spec (workspace/docs/modern-savage-klaviyo-setup-spec-2026-04-28.pdf).

LFG Outdoors Network — Source Media Group (Owen Leimbach) pitched CJ/Del: co-own an outdoor YouTube network with Bear, same model as their Source Golf launch (Bryson DeChambeau, Grant Horvat). First year costs: "very low 7 figures." Key unanswered question: is Bear expected to write a capital check or just contribute brand and content? Don't let CJ commit to anything without knowing the answer. Brief at workspace/docs/lfg-outdoors-network-brief-2026-04-28.pdf.

Henri-Lloyd — Emilia Renshaw has been waiting for Arctic content and boat details since before you sailed. She sent a detailed WhatsApp asking for: boat type/length/restoration background, route details, more imagery. She was working on an Instagram caption about your voyage. You now have all of it. Email draft ready at workspace/docs/draft-henri-lloyd-emilia-may21-2026-04-29.md — attach 3-5 expedition photos and send. Two asks from your side: (1) ambassador announcement timing, (2) boat restoration story. The kit was on every mile of the Arctic route — make that the headline.

PART 4 — The Non-Modern-Savage Stack

Item	Status	What to do
Wildernests contracts	Both signed April 22 (services + equity agreements)	No action needed - confirmed complete
Wildernests 3D model	Jesse gave revision notes April 23, team said "amending"	Check if corrected video delivered - needed for May launch
Tattarang (Taki Dermedgoglou)	Taki sent 6 diligence questions April 23 (production capacity, 5-year plan, pre-order deposits, P&L). Not answered as of April 28.	Ask CJ: has Alex answered Taki's questions? If not, brief + answers at workspace/docs/wildernests-tattarang-diligence-2026-04-25.pdf. Elliot Goldstone (Tattarang investment team) is cc'd. Silence past June = cooling risk.

Item	Status	What to do
Alfred pitch	May 5 coffee with Tom Inskip and Alice (Liberty Global, Chelsea). Jesse went in with a fully built pitch site (bearwitness-x-alfred.netlify.app) - built with an Indonesian developer, Raemy saw it April 23 and said "smashed it. super call. well done!" Alfred is a £20/month UK membership for wholesale utility pricing (energy, broadband, mobile, home/car insurance). Bear Witness pitching as digital media partner - retainer + equity.	Ask CJ what the outcome was. The pitch was unusually well-prepared - Jesse had a live branded strategy site, not just a verbal. If Tom Inskip responded positively, there's likely a follow-up step CJ is tracking.
Rick Landman callback	+447624277888 - 30-second bank verification	Bear Witness £6,000 payment held pending this call. Check if resolved.
Luminox 2nd amendment	Mondaine sent redlined amendment April 2. CJ replied April 20 "pending review." As of April 29 (27 days since their redline), still unsigned. Terms agreed: 6 feed posts/year, stories promotional, YouTube at Bear's discretion, LinkedIn Mondaine-originated. Key deal: Beanstalk (30% commission) exits September 2026 — CJ negotiated this out. From October, BGV keeps full royalties. Q1 2026 royalties: "not terrible" vs Q1 2025's $3,767.	Ask CJ: did this get signed during the sailing window? If not, it's been 7+ weeks since Mondaine's redline. A response is overdue. Priority: sign before Beanstalk exit creates any ambiguity. André Bernheim (A.Bernheim@mondaine.ch) is the marketing relationship to build once signed.
BPS Hub (Battersea Power Station)	Active email thread - NOT just with Sam Cotton. Full thread: March 31 George Musgrave (Asset Manager, GMusgrave@bpsdc.co.uk) told Jesse the office element doesn't fit BPS policy (they want customer-facing only). Jesse replied April 1: "package deal, all-three or nothing" and walked away politely. Same day, Jesse forwarded to Bear. Bear then emailed George directly (going off-script): enthusiastically pitched the hub vision, described Modern Savage as "bison testicles launching this month," Dirtea iced coffee, BMF fitness classes. George replied April 2 supportively but realistic - "pushing it internally." Bear followed up again April 24 ("Any update? And on costs for these units?") while Jesse was on AG set in Georgia. Georgia Siri (GSiri@bpsdc.co.uk) was also cc'd by Bear.	Urgent: loop back in before George responds to Bear's cost request. Bear may say yes to numbers without checking Jesse or Raemy. Raemy must be involved in any lease discussion (Bear has equity in all 3 hub businesses: Modern Savage, Dirtea 7.8%, BMF 33.3%). Bear described Modern Savage as "launching this month" (April) to George - expectation management needed if lease talks resume. CJ should also be briefed before Bear does anything further.

Item	Status	What to do
Ships A Lot Qwilr	Jesse said "happy to move forward" April 24, Slack #modern-savage set up same day	Still needs Qwilr signature. CJ's Q5 in the debrief.
Amazon launch setup	Amazon FBA day one is impossible - product ships June 17-July 15, FBA needs inventory positioned 4-6 weeks before launch. GTINs (barcodes, $250, gs1us.org) and Seller Central account should have been set up during sailing window. Full gap analysis at workspace/docs/modern-savage-amazon-setup-brief-2026-04-26.pdf.	Ask Calvin: (1) Are GTINs registered? (2) Is Seller Central account live? (3) Has he decided FBM vs FBA for day one? Recommended: FBM on July 1 (Ships A Lot fulfills Amazon orders), transition to FBA with second production run. If Seller Central isn't set up, this is Day 1 urgent — it takes 7 days for Amazon to verify the account.
Carson Combs (Zenbuild)	33, American, Christian, London-based. Bear intro via "Jim" (faith network) Feb 2026. Also runs outdoor western clothing brand Out Yonder Co. WhatsApp April 26: "have something for you to look at." You connected with him on Instagram over your painting.	Reply warmly - this is a personal intro from Bear. The pitch is likely Out Yonder Co (investment or collab), not Zenbuild building materials. Low urgency, reply in first week back.
Fat Cow (Ryan Porter)	UK tallow skincare brand (ryan@fatcowskin.com). Zoomed April 9 (29 min) - Jesse tried samples, loved the deodorant. April 24 evening WhatsApp to Ryan: "moisturiser, sun cream, deodorant. All branded Modern Savage x Fat Cow. Individual + bundle on Modern Savage UK + Fat Cow site." Ryan confirmed applicators come in black/silver/green base + one print colour (more options from manufacturer). Jesse missed the April 27 call (on set). Ryan is waiting.	Book a 30-min call with Ryan first week back. Hero product: deodorant (Jesse asked about applicator branding specifically). 3-SKU line: moisturiser + sun cream + deodorant. Decide: base colour (black/silver/green) + print treatment. Fat Cow makes in-house. Quick win - concept agreed, just needs product design locked.
AIR ONE eVTOL collab	Bear had an Instagram conversation with Gil Charnes (Marketing Manager, gil@airev.aero). Gil followed up April 26 with a non-paid collab pitch. AIR is an Israeli eVTOL startup - $50M total raised ($23M Series A July 2025, Entrée Capital + Mobileye early investor). AIR ONE: 2-seat piloted electric aircraft, targeting FAA MOSAIC/LSA certification 2027 (first eVTOL as Light Sport Aircraft). They already deliver an uncrewed 250kg cargo version. Florida test base active. Jesse replied April 28: "hold until we can	Monitoring. No action needed on return unless Gil follows up. If AIR ONE reaches FAA certification in 2027 this is a natural Running Wild / Adventure Garage tie-in. Check if Gil replied after April 28.

Item	Status	What to do
	purchase one of your aircraft" - warm hold, door open.	
Dare.live (Fr3y / SAFT)	BGV made a SAFT investment in Dare.live in July 2025. Raemy signed as Bear's POA. Jesse was supposed to coordinate the fund transfer with Bear - status unknown 9 months later. Frey (fr3yxyz@gmail.com) and Raemy were on a call April 29. A SAFT = pay now, receive tokens on launch. If the platform hasn't launched in 9 months, that's worth noting.	Ask Raemy: (1) Did the fund transfer from Bear/BGV to Dare.live actually happen? (2) What token allocation does BGV hold, and at what valuation? (3) Is the platform live? If funds were never sent, the SAFT is in limbo - get clarity before any new commitment.
Bear + Substack	Farrah Storr (Head of Writer Partnerships UK, MBE, ex-Elle/Cosmopolitan editor) called April 29 at 4PM. Caroline Michel (PFD, Bear's literary agent) brokered the intro - she's been pushing this for two years. Substack: 35M active subscriptions globally, creator keeps 90% of revenue. Economics: 5,000 paid subscribers at £10/month = £540K/year. Bear's book readership is millions - even 0.5% conversion is 5,000 from day one. Call prep built at workspace/docs/substack-call-prep-2026-04-29.pdf.	Ask Caroline and Jesse: how did the April 29 call go? If Farrah gave launch support commitments (cross-promotion, featured placement), this is a major opportunity. Key decisions: (1) Q3 launch target - is Bear committed? (2) Format: writing-only or audio too? (3) Free/paid ratio before going paid. Do NOT commit to a launch date without knowing Bear's bandwidth. Farrah's recommendation on format is the key output to get from CJ/Caroline. Note: no exclusivity discussion until terms are understood.
Glint (GlintPay)	Bear co-invested via Shay O'Brien (Bray Capital Ltd). March 26 shareholder update: £123.6M revenue, first net profit Jan 2026, $12M funding round open at £0.18/share with pre-emption rights for existing shareholders. Bear impressed ("It reads really well").	Ask Bear: did you exercise pre-emption rights in the $12M round? If not, the window may still be open - or may have closed. Jason Cozens CEO (jason@glintpay.com).
Ted's Health April 29 catchup	Thomas Filmer (thomas@tedshealth.com) convened a Ted's Health catchup April 29 at 9am. Jesse accepted but was off — CJ attended instead. Ted's has active supplement development underway (separate from Modern Savage): Thomas and Olly Westmacott chose "option 2: dark top and teal bottom" colour palette (April 16). Thomas also flagged Evaro (evaro.com) as a direct competitor to the white-label clinic pivot — worth reviewing.	Ask CJ: what was discussed at the April 29 Ted's Health meeting? Any decisions made, any blockers? Do NOT action Ted's Health work without Jesse explicitly asking.

Item	Status	What to do
MODERN SAVAGE USPTO trademark	Jesse called Weinberg Gonser LLP (Kylee MacArthur, kylee@wgcounsel.com) April 24. She quoted ~$2,500 to file, IP partner (Doug) did high-level review, expects it to go through without back-and-forth. Jesse forwarded internally to Tom@beargryllsventures.com and Raemy April 24. Kylee also emailed Tom directly ("FW: Connect: Jesse x Kylee"). Status: unknown if engagement letter was signed and filing initiated before sailing.	Ask Tom: is the Modern Savage trademark filed? If not, priority - you want this in before July 1 launch. Filing now still gives time for initial USPTO review before public launch.
Adventure Garage filming	AG was filming April 24-27 in Georgia (Day 3 of 4 on April 26). This explains why Jesse missed Fat Cow Zoom (April 27) and was hard to reach that week.	Offshore content from AG shoot - contact production for raw footage.
Water2	You called Charles Robinson April 28, just before sailing. Bear holds 5% (500 shares, £250K invested Feb 2024, company valued at £5M then — worth £1.8-3.6M now at current ARR). Original deal includes 10% quarterly profit share for Bear's promotional work. In March 2026 you tried to renegotiate this to a royalty — Charles rejected it in writing March 24 (royalties hurt exitability; Huel example). He remains "open to the conversation." What you don't know until you debrief yourself: did the April 28 call go well? Full deal context at workspace/docs/water2-call-prep-2026-04-25.md.	Remember: DON'T re-propose a royalty (Charles rejected in writing). The right structure is equity warrants for ongoing brand work, additive to the 5% + profit share. Outstanding questions that may still be unresolved: (1) has the quarterly profit share actually been paid? (2) does Bear have anti-dilution protection on the 5%? If you didn't get answers on the call, email c@water2.com and ask. If the call went well, push for heads of terms by end of May.
Becoming X resignation	Bear's formal resignation was due by May 6	Confirm it's done
Sister Swims trademark	UK00004372256 - opposition window ~June 24	No action needed, awareness only

The 5-Question Verbal Debrief with CJ (do this before reading email)

1. Ship date from Lightning Nutra — confirmed or not?
2. Domain acquisition — where are we with MediaOptions?
3. EBG May 4 call — what was agreed? Did Bear commit to anything?
4. Has Twyn's model arrived?
5. Is Stripe live? Was Ships A Lot Qwilr signed?

If all five have clean answers, you're in good shape. If any are red — start there.

Built April 28, 2026 by Junior. Updated April 29 (x5): DOAC removed; pricing + IG arc added; EBG 15% intel; Calvin SOW; Wildernests contracts confirmed; 3D check; Rick Landman; Ships A Lot/Carson Combs; Olly hospital; Tattarang correction; Glint pre-emption rights. Updated April 29 (6): Carson Combs corrected - personal intro (faith/art), Out Yonder Co is the likely pitch. Updated April 29 (7): AIR ONE eVTOL collab added. Updated April 29 (8): Luminox 2nd amendment status added - Mondaine's April 2 redline sat 27 days with CJ, may still be unsigned on return. Updated April 29 (9): Fat Cow corrected - 3 products (moisturiser, sun cream, deodorant) per April 24 WhatsApp, not one. Updated April 29 (10): Alfred pitch corrected - Jesse had a fully built pitch site (bearwitness-x-alfred.netlify.app) going into the May 5 coffee, not just a verbal. Updated April 29 (11): MODERN SAVAGE USPTO trademark added (Weinberg Gonser LLP, ~$2,500, Jesse forwarded to Tom@bgv + Raemy April 24 - ask Tom if filed). Adventure Garage filming context added (April 24-27 in Georgia). Updated April 29 (12): BPS Hub corrected - Bear has been emailing George Musgrave directly since April 1, described Modern Savage as "launching this month," followed up April 24 asking for costs. Jesse needs to loop back in before George responds. Updated April 29 (13): Water2 added - live equity negotiation, April 28 call with Charles Robinson, Bear holds 5% + 10% quarterly profit share, royalty rejected March 24, outstanding: has profit share been paid? anti-dilution on the 5%? Updated April 29 (14): Henri-Lloyd updated - Emilia was waiting for Arctic content before sailing, draft email ready at workspace/docs/draft-henri-lloyd-emilia-may21-2026-04-29.md. Ted's Health April 29 catchup noted - CJ attended in Jesse's place, ask CJ for debrief. Updated April 29 (15): Bear's personal letters for Wim Hof and Ross Edgley drafted and ready at workspace/docs/modern-savage-bear-letters-wim-ross-2026-04-29.md - influencer seeding May 23 task now takes 5 minutes not 30. Ship date and domain are the two live blockers. Updated April 29 (16): AIR ONE updated - Jesse replied "hold until we can purchase one of your aircraft," warm hold, door open. Dare.live/Fr3y row added - SAFT July 2025, fund transfer status unknown, Frey + Raemy call April 29, check outcome with Raemy on return. Bear + Substack row added - Farrah Storr (Head of Writer Partnerships UK) call April 29, Caroline Michel (PFD) brokered; economics strong (5K subs = £540K/year); call prep at workspace/docs/substack-call-prep-2026-04-29.pdf; ask Caroline how it went.